

THE PLAYER-COACH PLAYBOOK

Lesson 4

Activate Your M.V.P. Under Pressure

About 40 minutes of reps this week. Your core rep, Drill 4.4, the agility question, happens inside one real conversation.

M.V.P. Accelerator™

POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™

LESSON 4 · GOES WITH VIDEO 4.1

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 4

Welcome to Lesson 4. A plan is just a theory until it meets reality. This week is about activating your M.V.P. when it matters most, when the pressure is on and the stakes are high.

This is where leadership is truly revealed and conditioned, and where your Resilience and Agility are tested.

> **"Pressure is a privilege. It only comes to those who have earned it."**
>
> Billie Jean King

This week's A.R.A.W. focus:

Resilience Agility

Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- Develop your personal "Resilience Playbook" to consciously manage your reactions under stress.
- Learn to diagnose the root cause of resistance to change within your team.
- Practice coaching for agility to help your Athleader and team pivot effectively.



START HERE

Drill 4.4: The Agility Coaching Question

Your core rep this week, about 15 minutes.

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LESSON 4 · ABOUT 40 MINUTES OF REPS THIS WEEK

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills

Lead self first, then lead others. Your core rep happens inside one real conversation this week.

Drill 4.2

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

Your Resilience Playbook

Resilience · lead self

10 min

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Drill 4.3

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

Diagnosing Resistance to Change

Agility · lead others

15 min

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Drill 4.4

CORE REP · START HERE

The Agility Coaching Question

Agility · lead others

15 min

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Fill it in on screen. Type straight into the grey boxes and tick the boxes that apply. Save the file to keep your answers.

Or on paper. Print the pages and write by hand.

Then get feedback. Complete your core rep, then ask the person you coached how it landed.

Drill 4.2 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 10 minutes · Goes with Video 4.2

LEAD SELF: Your Resilience Playbook

Your team's resilience is a direct reflection of your own. An emotionally regulated leader promotes psychological safety and clear thinking. This drill helps you move from being reactive to being responsive by defining your go-to plays for staying calm and focused under pressure.

Identify two or three common stress triggers and design a specific "Resilience Play" for each.

Common Stress Trigger What is a recurring situation at work that causes you to feel stressed, overwhelmed, or reactive?	**My "Resilience Play"** What is one simple, immediate action you can take to create a pause between the trigger and your reaction?	**A.R.A.W. Pillar Strengthened** Wellbeing, Resilience, etc.
Example *Receiving an unexpected, critical email from a senior leader.*	**Example** *Stand up, walk to get water. Do not reply for at least 10 minutes.*	**Example** *Wellbeing / Resilience*

Your First Move

In the video, a CEO puts 10 minutes between the news and her response. Write your own first move.

What triggers it: _____

What I'll do for 10 minutes: _____

Where I'll do it: _____

Drill 4.3 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 15 minutes · Goes with Video 4.3

LEAD OTHERS: Diagnosing Resistance to Change

Resistance to change is rarely about the change itself; it's about a perceived loss. Your play as a Player-Coach is to listen beyond the surface-level complaints to diagnose what your team fears they will lose. Understanding this is the key to unlocking buy-in.

Think of a recent change you led (or are currently leading). Analyze the resistance to identify the primary root fear.

Step 1

The Change Initiative

Briefly describe the change.

Step 2

The Root Fear

Based on your team's questions and behaviors, what was the primary fear driving resistance? Check the most dominant one and provide your evidence below.

- ☐ **Loss of Certainty** (fear of the unknown, ambiguity, lack of a clear plan)
- ☐ **Loss of Competence** (fear of not being able to adapt, learn new skills, or succeed in the new environment)
- ☐ **Loss of Connection** (fear of a change to team dynamics, relationships, or informal networks)

Evidence / Observations

What did you see or hear that points to this specific fear?

Coaching Corner

Understanding this fundamentally changes how you will lead the next change. How can you proactively address this specific fear the next time you introduce a new initiative? *Write the questions you'll ask in a one-on-one.*

Drill 4.4 | Core rep · start here | About 15 minutes · Goes with Video 4.4

LEAD OTHERS: The Agility Coaching Question

A Player-Coach who always provides the answer creates dependency. A Player-Coach who asks powerful questions builds Agility. Your role is to build your Athleader's capacity to solve problems by shifting from "problem-solver-in-chief" to "question-asker."

Add the following powerful question to your coaching toolkit. The next time your Athleader brings you a problem, resist the urge to solve it and make this your first response.

"That's a tough challenge. What's your initial read on a path forward?"

Your Go-To Agility Question

Or the question from the lesson, when a constraint lands:

"What does this new constraint make possible?"

Practice Plan

Identify a specific, upcoming situation or meeting where you can practice using this question this week.

Situation / Person

Reflection: How does asking this question first, instead of providing a solution, change the dynamic of the conversation?

Your core rep: use it in one real conversation and note what changed when you asked a question instead of providing a solution.

Locker Room Reflection

Challenge and Self-Scouting: When you are under pressure, does your team see you as a source of calm or a source of stress? What is one specific behavior you can change this week (leveraging your Resilience Playbook from Drill 4.2) to better model resilience and composure for your team?

This reflection goes with the real-world challenge from Video 4.4.

My notes:

Get Feedback

Complete your core rep, then ask the person you coached how it landed.

Who I asked: _____

What they said, and what I'll keep doing:

Back in the course: your Athleader Pro Huddle with Dr. Michael Mannino, then your Pulse Check.